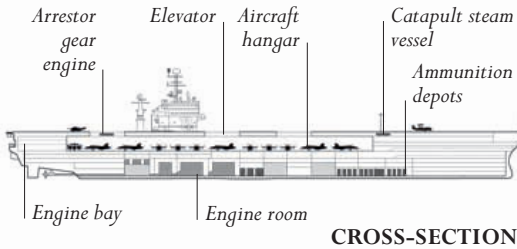
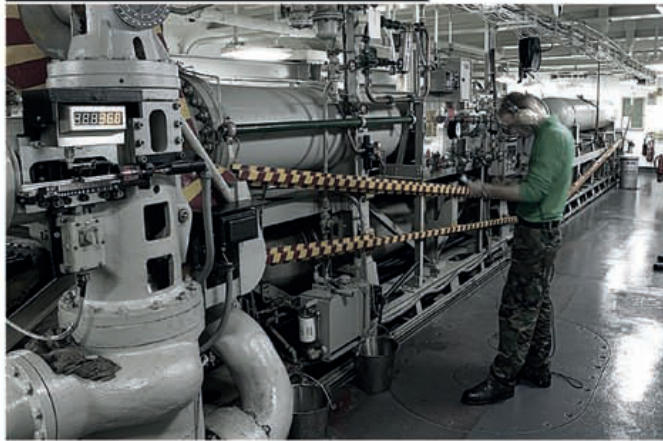


INSIDE AND DOWN BELOW

The control rooms are based in the island superstructure up above and elsewhere below deck. In addition to the aircraft hangar, the lower-deck areas include the catapult and arrestor gear machinery, 44 magazines, and the power plant and engine room. Facilities for the thousands of crew and air wing include messes, medical facilities, and a gym.



LAUNCH AND CATCH



▲ ARRESTING GEAR PISTON

Huge hydraulic pistons below the *George Washington's* flight deck provide the power to rein in the arrestor wires as they are caught by planes landing at speeds of up to 240kph (150mph).



▲ INSTRUMENT PANEL

Gauges show the steam pressure in the catapult mechanisms. The ship can launch four planes per minute.

CONTROL ROOMS



▲ PRIMARY FLIGHT CONTROL

Overlooking the deck, the air boss in charge of the ship's aircraft coordinates all take-offs and landings. The windows are angled to reduce glare.



▲ BRIDGE

The bridge gives panoramic views of the sky and ocean. From here, the captain or watch officer oversees navigation and steering.

AIRCRAFT HANGAR



▲ REACTOR CONTROLS

The reactors are controlled remotely from this room. The ship can run for a year on a fuel pellet the size of a soft drinks can. It has enough fuel to run non-stop for 18 years.



▲ NO. 3 PUMP ROOM

JP5 aviation fuel is pumped up to the flight deck. To reduce the risk of fire, JP5 has a lower ignition temperature than commercial fuel.

